Main Ethics Application Form

Guidance

Before you start

Note: Below is some helpful guidance completing this form. The form accepts plain text only (no special formatting). You can upload attachments to the form if special formatting is required (e.g. charts, illustrations etc.)



Please note that the session will time out after a period of inactivity. It is advised that you regularly **Save** to ensure no content is lost.



You can use the **Previous** or **Next** buttons to move throughout the form, or use the **Navigate** button to return to the navigation page. Begin from the **START HERE** button, to ensure the correct questions will appear on your form.



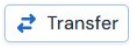
To share access to your form, use the **Roles** function, and you can also assign roles through **Assign Role** next to any of the contact boxes on the form. Use the **Collaborators** button to see their level of access



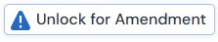
Use the **Completeness Check** to ensure that you have answered all of the relevant questions. Please note you will not be able to submit an incomplete form.



All student projects will require a supervisors signature. You can see a list of signatures here and any pending signature requests. You can **Unlock** an application once signed, but this will require a new signature to confirm changes.



You can **Transfer** your project to another researcher. Please note you will lose access to the project once this is complete.



You can **Unlock for Amendment** on any approved project. Please ensure you change your answer to Question 2. Failure to do so will result in delays.

Screening Tool for Researchers

1.0 Does your project involve any of the following?

- [x] Research involving human participants.
- [ ] Access to, collection or use of personal data or property, including mass data collected online (including from social media platforms).
- [ ] Access to, collection of or use of non-personal sensitive or confidential data.
- [ ] Research with the potential to expose any person, whether participating in the research or not, to physical or psychological harm.
- [ ] Research with the potential to cause a significant negative impact or damage to the environment.
- [ ] Research involving genetic material and the local or traditional knowledge relating to the genetic material.
- [ ] Research exploring or involving illegal activities, requiring access to or handling of materials related to illegal activities and/or research that could lead to the disclosure of information that could facilitate illegal activities.
- [ ] The collection and/or use of material derived from humans.

External approval screening

- [ ] Research involving His Majesty's Prison and Probation Services.
- [ ] Research requiring sponsorship and external approval from the Health Research Authority and/or NHS Research Ethics Committee.
- [ ] Research requiring external approvals from the Ministry of Defence Research Ethics Committee.
- [ ] Research involving animals, including both research covered by the Animals (Scientific Procedures) Act 1986 (ASPA) and non ASPA research involving animals and when relevant frameworks exist, to include research involving material derived from live or deceased animals.

Please click the below if none of the above from BOTH checklists apply

- [ ] None of the above.

New Application or Amendment

2.0. Initial or Amendment

- (•) New application or revision to initial application
- ( ) Amendment to an already approved application
- ( ) Amendment to an already approved application from Sussex Direct (Legacy System)

Please ensure that if your application has been unlocked for an amendment, that this above answer has been changed. This will ensure you are revealing all relevant questions on the form. Failing to do so will cause delays.

Applicant Details

2.1. Project Title Placement Project: MINT questionnaire validation follow-up

Applicant

Title	Miss
First Name	Asel
Surname	Tohlukov
Email	at775@sussex.ac.uk
Job Title	
Status	Undergraduate
Faculty	Faculty of Science, Engineering and Medicine
Department	Psychology

Supervisor

Title	Dr
First Name	Dominique
Surname	Makowski
Email	D.Makowski@sussex.ac.uk

Who is the Principal Investigator for this project?

If you are a student, this may be your supervisor. Please ask your supervisor to complete this question if you are unsure.

- ○ Applicant
- ◉ Supervisor
- ○ Another Researcher

Worktribe project ID (if applicable)

2.2. Is this project connected to your supervisors existing research or research data? (●) Yes ( ) No

Ethics application number of supervisor's previous project: ER/MB2021/2

2.5. Does the project involve any co-researchers from the University of Sussex? (●) Yes ( ) No

Co-researchers

Title	Miss
First Name	Ada
Surname	Erdem
Email	ae455@sussex.ac.uk
Status	Undergraduate

Please add all co-researchers under the roles feature if you require them to have access and correspondence related to this application

2.7. Does this project involve co-researchers from another institution? ( ) Yes (●) No

2.13. Is a data sharing agreement or contract required for your project? ( ) Yes (●) No

Project Overview

3.0. Proposed start date 06/10/2026

3.1. Proposed end date 01/10/2028

3.2. What type of project are you undertaking?

- [x] Research
- [ ] Service Evaluation
- [ ] Audit
- [ ] Impact
- [ ] Professional Practice
- [ ] Knowledge Exchange

3.4. Medical Specific Screening for SEM Faculty

Please tick all that apply, to ensure your application reaches the correct committee for review.

- [ ] Research which requires participants to be under medical supervision
- [ ] Research involving medical interventions, such as the use of imaging techniques/medical devices.
- [ ] Research relating to patient care and/or the way patient care is delivered
- [ ] Research exploring participants experience of health care or experience of health conditions
- [x] None of the above

3.5 Are you planning to conduct research involving NHS Patients, their tissue or their data, or conduct research which involves NHS Staff or working in the social care setting?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

3.6 Is this research project only using secondary data sources, with no primary data collection?

This does not apply to datasets collected from social media, which will require full ethical review.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

Project Details

4.0 **4.0. Description of project.**

4.0.1. Please provide a brief background summary and the context of your project.

This study is an online survey continuing the validation of the MINT, a new questionnaire measuring interoception: how people sense and make sense of the signals from inside their body, such as their heartbeat, breathing or stomach. The previous study (ER/MB2021/2) established the structure of the MINT and its relationships with other interoceptive scales. The present study repeats its design, procedure, recruitment, consent arrangements and data handling, with the same research team, in a new and larger sample, to replicate that structure and to examine the MINT's convergent and discriminant validity.

The core of the study, completed by all participants and the only part for which credit or payment is given, takes about 20 to 25 minutes. After the information sheet and consent form, participants answer:

- standard demographic questions, the same set our group collects across its studies (see 5.7.1);
- a brief personality inventory and single-item trait scales;
- the MINT, the questionnaire being validated;
- a questionnaire on beliefs about artificial intelligence (BAIT);
- symptom measures: anxiety and depression (PHQ-4), sleep quality, mental health history and the HiTOP Brief Report.

The MINT, the PHQ-4, the measure of life satisfaction, the mental health history, the measure of somatic complaints and the demographic questions were also asked in the previous study.

After each part, participants see a descriptive, non-diagnostic graphical summary of their answers. When the core is complete they are debriefed and given their credit, and may then stop, or continue through an optional set of further questionnaires for their own interest, which carries no reward. The measures, their order and the optional set are described under 4.1.1. (see examples in the attached items.docx.)

4.0.2. Please provide the research question and/or hypothesis.

The study asks three questions about the MINT:

1. Does the structure found in its first validation replicate in a new and larger sample? We expect its three dimensions (Bodily Awareness, Bodily Sensitivity and Bodily Clarity) to be recovered.
2. Does it show convergent and discriminant validity? We expect it to relate to measures of emotion regulation, emotion reactivity and affective and somatic symptoms, and to be distinct from general personality traits and from beliefs unrelated to the body.
3. Does the response format change the answers? Each participant is randomly assigned one of three formats (two seven-point scales labelled differently, or a slider), all scored the same way, to test whether the way a scale is presented affects responses to it.

Exploratory: how the MINT's dimensions relate to the six dimensions of psychopathology of the HiTOP Brief Report, which describes mental ill health as dimensions rather than diagnoses.

4.0.3. Please provide a rationale for the overall aims of the project and briefly summarise the expected benefits of your research to your participants or the wider community.

Interoception, the sensing and interpretation of signals from inside the body, is linked to emotion, self-awareness and mental health, but the questionnaires that measure it differ in what they capture. The MINT was developed to measure interoceptive traits more precisely. A new questionnaire is only useful once its structure has been replicated and its relationships with other constructs established in independent samples, which is what this study does. Testing whether the response format changes the answers is relevant to questionnaire research in general, and relating the MINT to the HiTOP framework places it within a current dimensional model of mental health.

Expected benefits: for the research community, a validated, freely available measure of interoception and an openly shared, de-identified dataset. For participants, an engaging survey that gives them immediate, descriptive feedback on each part, a debrief explaining the study, and, for students, first-hand experience of taking part in research. Participants' own judgements of whether the feedback describes them are themselves informative about how well the measures work.

4.1. Which research methods do you plan to use?

Please tick all that apply

- ☐ Interviews
- ☑ Questionnaires
- ☐ Observation
- ☐ Focus Group
- ☐ Ethnographic methods
- ☐ Citizen Science
- ☐ Workshops
- ☐ Experimental
- ☐ Participatory Methods
- ☐ Another Research Method not listed

4.1.1. Please add details on your method/s here

The core set, completed by all participants, is:

- The MINT, the instrument under validation.
- A brief personality inventory (Five-Item Personality Inventory; Gosling et al., 2003) and a set of single-item trait scales measuring self-esteem, self-concept clarity, self-efficacy, meaning in life, life satisfaction, narcissism, self-rated health, perceived stress and the valuing and seeking of beauty, and two self-placements (how intelligent and how attractive the participant thinks they are, compared with other people).
- A questionnaire on beliefs about artificial intelligence technology (BAIT).
- Symptom measures: the PHQ-4, a single-item measure of sleep quality, reported mental health history, and the HiTOP Brief Report (Simms et al., 2026), which measures six dimensions of psychopathology over the past twelve months.

The optional set, offered after the core set, is:

- A fuller personality inventory (HEX-ACO-18; Olaru & Jankowsky, 2022) together with a short social desirability scale (KSE-G; Kemper et al., 2014).
- Questions inspired by the Pearson-Marr archetype indicator (PMAI).
- Five further scales of the Primals Inventory (Clifton et al., 2019).
- A short untimed reasoning test (ICAR-16 Sample Test; Condon & Revelle, 2014).
- Brief measures of attention and self-control (two items each from the ASRS, the Cognitive Failures Questionnaire, the Mind Wandering Scale and the Brief Self-Control Scale), six items of the Emotion Reactivity Scale and the short form of the CERQ.

- A set of questions on social and political views: a left-right self-placement (the European Social Survey item), three items adapted from the Conspiracy Mentality Questionnaire (Bruder et al., 2013), thirty-two agree/disagree statements on economic redistribution and social order (adapted from the British Social Attitudes scales; Evans et al., 1996), equality of outcomes between groups, human enhancement and heredity, the climate, nuclear power and the moral standing of animals, how much beauty should count against cost and use, and whether words alone can do lasting harm (adapted from the Words Can Harm Scale; Pratt et al., 2026), a question on whether a range of views or a range of backgrounds matters more, and a question on diet, most of them written or adapted for this study. These are political opinions and are treated as special category data (see 5.7.1 and 5.9.1); they are collected anonymously like the health items, and the feedback on them shows no percentile or ranking.

The survey always opens with age, month and day of birth and gender, and the brief trait scales. The participant then chooses the order of the three remaining parts of the core set (the MINT, the AI beliefs questionnaire, and the symptom measures): two of them, drawn at random for each participant, are offered first, and the participant picks which to answer, then picks between the one left and the third. The random draw means that no one instrument is always answered first and none always answered last. The other demographic questions open the second part, whichever it is (education, field of study, student status, ethnicity and country), and the third (financial comfort and social status). The items within each questionnaire are presented in a random order, except where an instrument was validated in a fixed order, in which case that order is kept. The optional questionnaires are offered three at a time, the participant choosing which to answer next. In both sets the choice changes only the order, never what is asked.

The complete list of every questionnaire and every item asked, with its source and reference, is published as part of the study documentation and can be consulted at https://realitybendinglab.com/TestYourself/docs/ (select the "Content" slide, and any row of the table to see that instrument's items). A PDF copy is attached under 6.6.1.

Optional continuation

After completing the core set, participants are told that they have completed the main part of the study and are given the link that awards their credit. They may then either stop or continue through the optional questionnaires for their own interest. The continuation is entirely voluntary, carries no additional reward, and may be abandoned at any point; receiving credit does not depend on it, and participants are told so.

Feedback and debriefing

After each part, participants are shown a graphical summary of their own answers, and are asked whether it matches their experience of themselves and how they found that part of the survey. These responses are themselves informative about how well the measures describe people. The summary is descriptive and explicitly non-diagnostic: no clinical label, cut-off or risk score is shown at any point.

When the core set is complete, participants are asked whether they took the survey seriously, may write any comments they wish to share, and are shown a debriefing screen stating the aim of the study, explaining interoception and the random assignment of the response format, reminding them that their answers are confidential and stored de-identified, giving the research team's contact details and signposting sources of support. Those who continue through the optional set are asked the same two questions again at the end.

4.2. Is this research going to be funded by a grant? ○ Yes ◉ No

4.3. Will your project involve the utilisation of non-human genetic resources (including any associated traditional knowledge) sourced from outside the UK?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

Does your project involve any of the following?

5.0. A physical risk to participants and/or the researcher

e.g. collection of human materials, administration of food, drugs, placebos or other substances, the use, production, storage, waste, transportation and/or release of chemicals and hazardous (biological agents, flammable/dangerous/explosive substances, biological agents etc.) or equipment, the use of physical agents (excessive noise exposure, ionizing radiation, electromagnetic fields) or use of invasive or potentially harmful procedures.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

5.1. Potential to induce psychological stress, distress or anxiety, or produce humiliation or cause harm or other negative consequences

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

5.2. Studies that may lead to disclosures from the participant that raise ethical or moral dilemmas, involvement in illegal actions or risk of harm to themselves or others

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

5.3. Involvement of participants who could be considered vulnerable or could feel coerced or obliged to take part, or disadvantaged by not taking part.

e.g. people who are unable to give informed consent or in a dependent position, people under 18 years of age, people with learning disabilities, over-researched groups or people in care facilities

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

5.4. Deception and/or participation without consent (incl covert observation of people in non-public places). Please refer to the British Psychological Society Code of Ethics and Conduct (or similar guidelines) for further information.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

5.5. Potential to identify research participants in publications or outputs.

This does not include taking email details for participant prize draws or identifying participants from signed consent forms or holding identity encryption spreadsheets that are stored securely separate from the research data.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

5.6. Research exploring or involving illegal activities, requiring access to or handling of materials related to illegal activities and/or could lead to the disclosure of information that could facilitate illegal activities.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

5.7. The collection of personal, special categories of personal data*

identifiers relating to racial, or ethnic origin, political opinions, trade union membership, religious or philosophical beliefs, genetics data, biometrics data, health, data concerning sex life or sexual orientation.

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

5.7.1. Please explain why the collection of any special categories of personal data is necessary for your project and why the project aims cannot be achieved without collection of this data.

A Data Protection Impact Assessment may also be required, so please contact a Data Protection Officer for advice

Participants are asked to report their age, gender, ethnicity, educational level and country of current residence, and to answer standard self-report questionnaires which include items about mental health history and about psychological and somatic symptoms. Participants who choose to go on past the core set may also answer a set of questions on their social and political views, of the kind asked in general population social surveys.

These demographic variables are collected for two reasons. First, for continuity with our group's existing studies: we have collected the same demographic information throughout, and keeping the set identical is what allows datasets from different studies to be pooled, compared and reused. Second, because characterising the composition of a sample is a central part of questionnaire validation. The psychometric properties of an instrument are established in a particular sample, and the diversity of that sample, or its lack of diversity, is what determines how far the findings can be generalised. Reporting these variables is what allows us and other researchers to be critical about representation, to avoid overgeneralising, and to identify where validation in other cultural and linguistic contexts is needed.

The health measures are needed because establishing how interoception relates to symptoms of mental and physical ill health is one of the aims of the study: a questionnaire of interoception cannot be validated against these constructs without measuring them. The questions on social and political views are in the optional set only; they provide constructs the MINT should not be strongly related to (discriminant validity), and allow the relationship between bodily awareness and social attitudes to be explored.

5.8. Please outline any other ethical issues that you think are relevant to your project and not covered elsewhere, including potential conflicts of interest.

None beyond those covered above. There are no conflicts of interest.

Based upon your answers to the above questions your application may be considered **HIGH** risk.

If, however you wish to make a case that your application should be considered as **LOW** risk please enter the reasons here. Researchers should note that SREOs or F-RECs may decide NOT to agree with the case that you have made.

5.9. Would you like your application to be considered as LOW risk?

- (•) Yes
- ( ) No

5.9.1. Please summarise why:

Participants are asked to report their age, gender, ethnicity, educational level and country of current residence, and to answer standard self-report questionnaires which include items about mental health history and about psychological and somatic symptoms. Participants who choose to go on past the core set may also answer a set of questions on their social and political views, of the kind asked in general population social surveys.

These demographic variables are collected for two reasons. First, for continuity with our group's existing studies: we have collected the same demographic information throughout, and keeping the set identical is what allows datasets from different studies to be pooled, compared and reused. Second, because characterising the composition of a sample is a central part of questionnaire validation. The psychometric properties of an instrument are established in a particular sample, and the diversity of that sample, or its lack of diversity, is what determines how far the findings can be generalised. Reporting these variables is what allows us and other researchers to be critical about representation, to avoid overgeneralising, and to identify where validation in other cultural and linguistic contexts is needed.

All data are anonymised at the point of collection. No name, email address or IP address is recorded, and each set of responses carries only a randomly generated participant code. Where a participant comes from a recruitment platform, the code that platform uses in order to award credit or payment is also recorded, so that a completed run can be matched to its reward if a query arises; it holds no personal information, it can be resolved to a person only within that platform, and it is removed before any data are published. The day of birth is asked only to derive the star sign shown in the feedback; since, together with the month and the age, it approaches a date of birth, it is likewise removed, or replaced by a coarser grouping such as the star sign, before any data are published. The research team cannot link a set of responses to an individual. No item asks about suicidal ideation, self-harm or illegal activity. The health items and the questions on social and political views are special category data under UK GDPR Article 9; they are collected under the same anonymity as everything else, and the feedback on the political items shows a participant their own position, with no percentile or ranking.

The graphical summary shown to participants at the end of each part is descriptive and explicitly non-diagnostic: no clinical label, cut-off or risk score is shown at any point. The debriefing screen signposts sources of support.

Questionnaires of this kind, with immediate personal feedback, are widely and freely available online, including on mental health and political attitudes: NHS services offer anonymous online low-mood and anxiety questionnaires that return a score, Project Implicit has long given the public feedback on their implicit attitudes about race, gender and sexuality, and sites such as taketest.xyz score several of the instruments used here against normed samples. Taking part therefore exposes participants to nothing beyond what they encounter in everyday life, and the feedback here is more cautious than most, presenting no score, percentile or ranking on the symptom measures.

Recruitment

6.0. **How many participants do you plan to recruit? Please provide an estimate if unknown at this point.**

If this is a secondary data study, please include the number of data points.

300

6.0.1. Please detail the justification for your sample size.

The study aims to recruit a minimum of 300 participants for the core set of questionnaires. This is in line with the sample sizes of comparable validation studies and is considered adequate for the confirmatory factor analysis of a questionnaire's structure. With 300 participants, the study has 80% power to detect correlations of r = .16 or larger (two-tailed, alpha = .05), which covers the small-to-moderate relationships expected between the MINT and the other measures, and to detect a small-to-moderate difference (f = .18) between the three randomly assigned response formats.

6.1. Please explain how participants will be selected including any inclusion and exclusion criteria.

Participants are adults aged 18 or over, recruited through participant recruitment platforms (SONA and Prolific) and through posts on social media. There are no exclusion criteria other than the minimum age.

6.2. Will you require cooperation of a gatekeeper in order to access participants?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

6.3 Will you be inviting participants to take part in this research project?

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

6.3.1 How will initial contact be made with participants?

Please note that if you are recruiting participants via social media, a separate profile should be created (using a university e-mail address or a dedicated study webpage, etc.). Please also review the University's guidance on social media.

Please explain how you will have appropriate access to your participant cohort(s) that is compliant with data protection laws.

Participants will be recruited via online recruitment platforms - SONA, the University's own participant pool, and Prolific - and potentially by convenience sampling via social media, through posts on the research group's own accounts linking to the study. The samples from different methods of recruitment will be collected separately in case they differ (the incentive type, e.g., student credits or payment, and its amount, or the absence of one, will thus be known and can be accounted for). No personal data are obtained in recruiting: people follow a link and take part anonymously.

Participants recruited through SONA receive course credit, and participants recruited through Prolific are paid at no less than the University's minimum rate for study compensation, for completing the core set of questionnaires. The optional questionnaires offered afterwards carry no additional credit or payment, and participants are told this before deciding whether to continue.

Data Collection

6.4. Will you be using your University of Sussex or BSMS email address for email correspondence.

- [x] Yes
- [ ] No

6.5. Please upload copies of the invitation text such as poster, email and web advertisements.

Documents

Type	Document Name	File Name	Version Date	Version	Size
Other Participant Materials	advert	advert.docx			131.1 KB

6.6 Will you be using any of the following: questionnaires, topic guides, interview structure, debriefs.

- (•) Yes
- ( ) No

6.6.1 **Please upload any participant facing documents related to your intervention, i.e. questionnaires, topic guides, interview structure, debrief.**

Your information sheet and consent form should uploaded later in the form in their respective sections.

Documents

Type	Document Name	File Name	Version Date	Version	Size
Other Participant Materials	debrief	debrief.docx	04/10/2026	1	131.3 KB
Other Participant Materials	items	items.docx	08/10/2026	2	416.8 KB

6.7 Will you be showing participants any photo's/pictures/audio/visual recordings/clips? ( ) Yes (•) No

If your research intervention and materials are likely to develop once the research has begun, please include as much information as possible about the planned research intervention and materials you will use.

6.8 Will participants be provided with a Participant Information Sheet?

- (•) Yes
- ( ) No

6.8.1 Please upload a copy of your Participant Information Sheet.

You are encouraged to utilise the template and guidance notes for research studies:

www.sussex.ac.uk/staff/research/documents/partictipant-information-sheet-template.doc

www.sussex.ac.uk/staff/research/documents/pis-cf-why-do-i.pdf

Documents

Type	Document Name	File Name	Version Date	Version	Size
Participant Information Sheet	consent_form	consent_form.docx	08/10/2026	2	132.6 KB

6.9. Are you accessing participants or data containing personal data via an online environment or internet setting?

Please note that when researching over researched or potentially vulnerable groups, it is not appropriate to scrape from online groups which explicitly state that gatekeeper approval is required, or disallow data collection in their group T&Cs.

e.g. chat rooms, social media, instant messaging, online forums.

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

6.11. Do you intend to collect a large dataset to use for modelling in a machine learning project?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

6.12. Does this project involve the use and/or storage of human tissue?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

Informed Consent and Withdrawal

7.0. Will participants give consent to take part prior to their participation?

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

7.0.2. How will your participants give consent?

- ☑ In Writing/online form
- ☐ Verbally

7.0.4 **In Writing/online form**

Documents

Type	Document Name	File Name	Version Date	Version	Size
Written Consent Form	Written consent form	consent_form2.docx	08/10/2026	2	132.6 KB

Consent form templates can be found on our central website

Please find BSMS specific templates on the central BSMS website

7.1. Will questionnaires be completed anonymously and returned indirectly?

- (•) Yes
- ( ) No

7.2. How will you ensure that the participant information is provided in a suitable format for your target group? i.e, do they require language translation, child specific documents, written forms or oral consent?

Participants are adults, most of them university students, recruited online. The information sheet is written in plain English, is shown on screen before any question, and the survey cannot be started until it has been scrolled to the end. No translation, child-specific documents or oral consent are needed. The survey shows one question at a time and works on phones, tablets and computers. Participants are given the research team's contact details to ask any question before, during or after taking part.

7.3. How long will potential participants have to consider taking part in your study?

As long as they wish. The study advert describes the study before anybody follows the link, the information sheet can be read at the participant's own pace before starting, and the study stays open for the whole of data collection, so nobody has to decide on first reading. Participants can close the page at any time without having started.

7.4. Will participants be able to leave at any time during the study without giving a reason?

- (•) Yes
- ( ) No

7.5. Will participants be able to withdraw their research data?

- ( ) Yes
- (•) No

7.5.2. Please explain why participants are unable to withdraw their research data.

This will need to be clearly stated in the participation information sheet or justified if conducting research without consent

Participants are shown the information sheet and consent statements before any question is presented, and the survey cannot be started until the text has been read through to the end. Participants then click a button indicating that they have read and understood the information and consent to take part.

Participants are told that they may stop at any time, simply by closing the browser, and that they do not have to give a reason. They are also told that their answers are recorded as they give them rather than only at the end, so that the answers given before they stop are kept and may be used in the research, and that because the data are anonymous, responses cannot be identified and therefore cannot be withdrawn once they have been given.

This differs from the previous study (ER/MB2021/2), where answers were saved only at the end. The consent statements are the University's standard wording except the third, which said that withdrawing data would be impossible "once I have completed it" and now says "once it has been given, whether or not I finish the study".

7.6. Will participants be reimbursed or paid for their expenses and/or time or be offered to enter a prize draw?

- (•) Yes
- ( ) No

7.6.1. What re-imbursement/payment will participants receive and who is funding this?

SONA participants receive 2 course credits, the scheme's conversion for a study of about 30 minutes, and Prolific participants are paid at no less than the University's minimum rate for study compensation for 30 minutes, for completing the core set only; the optional continuation is unrewarded. Course credit has no cost.

7.7 Will researchers be publishing direct quotes from research outputs?

- ( ) Yes
- (•) No
- ( ) Not Applicable

Researcher/Participant Safety and Wellbeing

8.0. Is DBS (Disclosure and Barring Service) clearance necessary for this project?

- ( ) Yes
- (•) No

8.1. Will the research be conducted outside the UK? (not including research online)

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

8.2. Will any local (overseas) ethics or governance approvals or permissions be required in order to conduct the research?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

8.3. Please detail all the locations for your research (computer, field work, lab work).

The survey will be completed online, at a time and place of the participant's choosing.

8.4. Will participants be provided offered the option of a chaperone?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

8.5. Will any researchers be in a lone working situation?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

8.6. Will the study involve engaging participants in the discussion of potentially distressing or sensitive topics? (e.g. sexual activity, drug use, ethnicity, political behaviour, potentially illegal activities).

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

8.6.1. Please set out how you will manage the wellbeing of participants and where relevant include details of what support will be provided and/or signposted to.

The survey includes standard self-report items about psychological and somatic symptoms over the past two weeks and the past year, about mental health history and about ethnicity, and an optional set of questions on social and political views. These are routine items of the kind used in general population surveys, answered anonymously and not discussed with anybody, and no item asks about suicidal ideation or self-harm. Participants may stop at any point without giving a reason. The graphical summary of their answers is descriptive and explicitly non-diagnostic, and the debriefing screen signposts sources of support, including the Samaritans, Mind and the University's wellbeing services, together with the contact details of the research team.

8.6.2. Please set out how you will manage the wellbeing of your research group, including yourself.

The survey's topics are not distressing beyond everyday risk, and no staff member is required to work on any aspects that they might feel uncomfortable working on.

8.7. Can you think of anything else that might be potentially harmful to the research group?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

8.8. How will the findings of the study be fed back to participants in an accessible way?

Participants receive immediate, individual feedback throughout the survey: a descriptive, non-diagnostic graphical summary of their own answers after each part, and a debrief explaining the aims of the study when they finish the main part. The group findings will be published open access, with a freely available preprint, and the de-identified data will be shared on an open repository; both will be linked from the research group's website.

Data Storage/Management

9.1. Will data be transferred outside of the University of Sussex?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

9.2. Will you be transferring or receiving any personal data from outside of the UK?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

9.3. Will the Principal Investigator take full responsibility during the study, for ensuring the lawful collection of, appropriate storage of and security of information (including research data, consent forms and administrative records)?

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

9.4. Where will data be stored for the duration of the project?

Other

9.4.1. Where will the data be stored.

During data collection, responses are deposited in a private, unpublished Zenodo record (Zenodo being the research data repository operated by CERN) held by the research group and readable only by the research team: one file for a participant who finishes, and, for one who stops partway, a file of the responses given up to that point. For analysis, the files are downloaded to University-approved storage, where they are compiled into a single de-identified data file. Only that file is published, on an open repository.

Data Analysis / Management

9.5. Who will have access to personal information and data relating to this study and how will the results be analysed?

Only the research team has
access to the raw data, which are held in a private, unpublished repository record and on University-approved storage. No names, email addresses or IP addresses are collected; the only identifier a recruitment platform may supply (the code it uses to award credit or payment) can be resolved to a person only within that platform. Only the compiled, de-identified data file is made public.

The data will be analysed in R. The structure of the MINT will be tested by confirmatory factor analysis; its convergent and discriminant validity by its correlations with the other measures; the effect of the response format by comparing the three randomly assigned formats (measurement invariance and score distributions); and its relationship with the HiTOP Brief Report's six dimensions by correlation and regression. Results are reported at group level only.

9.5.1 What type of research data will your project be collecting? Please tick all appropriate boxes below:

9.5.1 What type of research data will your project be collecting? Please tick all appropriate boxes below:

- ☐ Paper written notes/field notes
- ☐ Email correspondence
- ☐ Audio recording of participants
- ☐ Audio/video recordings (e.g. Teams or Zoom calls)
- ☑ Survey/questionnaire responses (online) e.g. Qualtrics
- ☐ Medical data such as scan data or EEG readings
- ☐ Other electronic data e.g. diary entries, app data
- ☐ Other

9.5.3 Please detail how you will manage the types of data you are collecting (ticked above) and indicate what safeguards will be in place to ensure that data will be secure and compliant with data protection laws.

The survey is anonymous: no name, email address or IP address is collected. Each set of responses carries only a randomly generated participant code, which is created by the survey itself and is not linked to any identifying information.

Responses are transmitted through DataPipe (pipe.jspsych.org), a free, open-source service run by the developers of the jsPsych library, which forwards data from browser-based studies to a data repository, keeping no copy once they are delivered, without the researchers operating a server of their own. Each response is transmitted as it is given, and the complete set is transmitted again when the survey is finished, so that a participant who stops partway through still contributes the answers they had given. The data are deposited in a Zenodo record (Zenodo being the research data repository operated by CERN) held by the research group: one file for a participant who finishes, and, for one who stops partway, a file of the responses given up to that point, written about fifteen minutes after they stop.

That repository record is unpublished and private for the whole of data collection: it has no public address, it is not indexed, and it is readable only by the research team. The files in it are downloaded and compiled into a single de-identified data file, and it is at that stage that anonymisation is carried out - any identifier supplied by a recruitment platform is removed, the day of birth is removed or replaced by a coarser grouping (such as the star sign it falls under), and free-text responses are read and edited or deleted where they contain anything that could identify an individual. Only the compiled, de-identified file is made publicly available, as stated in the consent form that participants read and agree to before taking part.

Where participants are recruited through SONA or Prolific, the survey URL carries a code generated by that platform for the purpose of awarding credit or payment, and this code is recorded with the responses so that a completed run can be matched to its reward if a query arises. It contains no personal information and can be resolved to an individual only within that platform, by staff with access to that system; it is not resolvable by the research team from the research data, and it is removed before any data are published.

9.6. Will you require the use of transcription software?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

9.7. Is your research data already anonymous?

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

9.8. Please detail how long will raw data be retained, and how and when personal data will be deleted?

This includes audio/video files recorded for transcription purposes or media artifacts. Please state if these will be deleted upon transcription, or retained for future research and research outputs (this should be clearly identified in the PIS, consent and media release forms).

No audio, video or media files are recorded. The raw response files are kept, private, until data collection has ended and any credit or payment queries are resolved, and no later than the project end date. They are then compiled into a single de-identified data file: the identifier supplied by a recruitment platform is removed, the day of birth is removed or reduced to the star sign it falls under, and free-text responses are read and edited or deleted where they could identify anybody. The raw files are then deleted from the repository record and from University storage. The de-identified data file is kept indefinitely on an open research data repository, as stated in the consent form.

9.9. Will lists of identifiable numbers or pseudonyms linked to names and/or other personal information be stored securely and separately from the research data?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

9.9.1. Please explain why not.

No names are collected, and the research team holds no list linking a platform identifier to a person; such a list exists only inside SONA or Prolific, under those platforms' own governance.

9.10. Do you intend to use the research data for any purpose other than that for which consent is explicitly given?

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

9.11 Do you plan to publish identifiable information about participants? (such as including participant names in the write-up)

- ○ Yes
- ◉ No

9.12 Do you intend to present your research externally? (This might include publication, results in a conference).

- ◉ Yes
- ○ No

9.12.1. Please specify where:

Publications.

9.13 What will happen to anonymised data from the study after completion of the project? (Please tick all that apply).

- ☐ Data will be transferred to supervisor for future use
- ☑ Data will be used in future research projects
- ☑ Data will be published on an open access repository
- ☐ Data will be destroyed once award is conferred or project is complete
- ☐ Another use

9.14 How will you obtain consent to publish or use the data from this project in future research?

Consent is obtained before participation, through the consent statements participants agree to before starting: that their data will be stored in a de-identified way and may be made publicly available through secured scientific online data repositories, and that their data will be used for the purposes of this research and handled according to data protection legislation and the University's Privacy Notice. Only de-identified data are shared, so they can be reused in future research, including being pooled with the research group's other datasets on the same measures.

9.15 If you have had a change requested through track changes, and you want to discuss this with the F-REC or query this– please use this box to detail your argument

9.16 If you have any other documents to upload which are not specifically related to a question on the form, please attach these here.

Documents

Type	Document Name	File Name	Version Date	Version	Size
SAE Supporting Documentation	items_optional	items_optional.docx	08/10/2026		136.9 KB

Applicant

The declarations are to be completed by the applicant, please ensure that you read and sign at the end so your application will be submitted. Failure to do so will result in delays.

5. By submitting your own application, you are agreeing to the following declarations

- ☑ I confirm that I have read UoS Code of Practice for Research

  UoS Code of Practice for Research

  Research Governance Standard Operating Procedures (including ethical review)

- ☑ The information in this form is accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief, and I take full responsibility for it.
- ☑ I understand that I am responsible for monitoring the research at all times and recording any unexpected events.
- ☑ If any serious adverse events arise in relation to the research, I understand that I am responsible for immediately stopping the research and alerting the F-REC Chair within 24 hours of the occurrence.
- ☑ I am aware of my responsibility to comply with the current requirements of the law and relevant guidelines relating to security and confidentiality of personal data.
- ☑ I understand that research records / data may be subject to inspection for audit purposes if required in future.
- ☑ I understand that I may not commence this research until I have been notified that the project has ethical approval.
- ☑ If there is a substantial change in topic/methodology or risk categorisation I confirm that I will submit an amendment to outline the changes.
- ☑ Research records will be held in accordance with the Data Protection Act 2018 as detailed by University Guidance

  Data Protection Act 2018

  University Guidance

Use the 'Sign' button below to sign your application.

Signature

Signed: This form was signed by Ada Erdem (ae455@sussex.ac.uk) on 08/10/2026 5:02 PM

Steps to Request Signature from your Supervisor

Step 1. Give your supervisor access to your application using the 'Roles' Roles button (this will also share them into correspondence emails).

Step 2. Press the 'Request Signature' button below to request your supervisor to sign your application.

You supervisor will review your application and sign the form, and then your form will automatically be submitted for review. You will receive an email confirming once your application has been submitted.

Supervisor Signature

Signed: This form was signed by . Dominique Makowski (D.Makowski@sussex.ac.uk) on 08/10/2026 10:52 PM

For Supervisor: Signature Information

Please ensure that you have read the application in full and discussed any potential changes with the applicant before signing this off for review. Failure to do so will result in delay.

In reviewing and authorising a student's ethics application, you are confirming that all reasonable steps have been taken to ensure that the project is conducted ethically, provided the student follows what has been agreed. You are also confirming that you will be monitoring the student's project, as it proceeds.